

Depth In A Fast Paced World

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Shibashish Roy runs the country's largest electronics retail chain, Croma, which gives him an unusual vantage on both ends of the tech evolution: what brands ship, and what Indians actually buy. His view of the next 25 years sees the smartphone giving way to ambient computing, sustainability becoming non-negotiable, and retail itself transforming from product-pushing to experience-curating.

How has tech evolved over the past 25 years, and Digit's role in that journey?

Twenty-five years ago, owning a personal computer was an event in an Indian household. A 56K modem connecting to the internet felt revolutionary. Today, we have more computing power in our pockets than NASA used to reach the moon in 1969. We have gone from desktops to laptops to smartphones to AI-powered everything including connected refrigerators and smart wearables that read our heart rhythm. India hasn't just consumed this revolution; we have also shaped it.

Digit has been part of that journey from the early days. Long before YouTube reviews and influencer unboxings, Digit's rigorous benchmark testing and head-to-head comparisons guided Indian consumers on reading a spec sheet, what frame rates meant, and why build quality

mattered. For an entire generation of techies, many of whom now lead India's digital economy, Digit was the trusted first read before any purchase - a rare and enduring influence.

How will tech transform our lives in the next 25 years?

The next 25 years will be defined less by devices and more by intelligence. From being something, we consciously use to something that quietly works around us, AI will anticipate our needs, automating decisions, and personalising every experience! The smartphone, as we know it, will likely give way to ambient computing with glasses, earbuds, and surfaces that respond to voice, gesture, and context.

Homes will become genuinely intelligent ecosystems rather than varied collections of connected gadgets. Healthcare tech will shift

from reactive to predictive, with wearables flagging conditions before symptoms appear. Sustainability will be non-negotiable. Repairability, energy efficiency, and circular design will be basic expectations.

For retailers like Croma, the role evolves too. We will move from selling products to curating intelligent experiences to help our customers navigate increasingly complex choices in an AI-first world.

Message to Digit on completing 25 years

Two and a half decades is a remarkable milestone, especially in tech media. This is an industry where attention spans are measured in seconds. In such an ecosystem, Digit hasn't just survived; it has stayed relevant, trusted, and ahead of the curve through every wave from the PC era to mobile to AI.

What sets Digit apart is its commitment to depth in a world that has grown obsessed with speed. Real testing, real benchmarks, real reviews written for readers who genuinely want to understand technology, not just customers to sell products to.

On behalf of all of us at Croma, our heartfelt congratulations to the entire Digit team, past and present, on this incredible milestone. Here's to many more decades of helping Indians make smarter, more informed technology choices! 🇮🇳



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